

Lab:
A survey of corpora

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Topics to cover

- Continue working on Python basics
- A survey of corpora

Assignment 1 (Deadline: 9/11)

Each exercise is worth **2 points**. Total: **10 points**.

- **Exercise 1:** Submit your .py and .json
- **Exercise 2:** Submit your .py and .json
- **Exercise 3:** Submit your .py and .json
- **Exercise 4:** Submit your .py and .json

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- You may combine the `.json` files for Exercises 1–4 into a single file. If you do, please use a clear filename such as `Exercises1-4.json` so that I can easily identify it.

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- Put all files into a single `.zip` file and submit it to **Assignment 1** on Lamakū.

Exercise 4. Find the Longest Word in Each Line

Suppose you are given a text file called `sentences.txt`.

Example file:

```
I like corpus linguistics
Python is useful for text analysis
Natural language processing is fascinating
```

For each line, find and print the **longest word**.

Desired output:

```
linguistics
analysis
fascinating
```

► [hint!](#)

Exercise 5. Find a Corpus for Your Research

Find a corpus that could be useful for your research.

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For this lab, we will focus on **representativeness**. In approximately half a page, briefly describe:

- your research interest or possible research question;
- the corpus:
 - language(s)
 - population
 - modality / genre
 - approximate size
- why the corpus is useful for your research
- what part of the corpus or linguistic feature(s) you might analyze

Exercise 5. Evaluate the Corpus

Consider some of the following questions (but do not need to answer all of them):

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Consider some of the following questions (but do not need to answer all of them):

- What population or language-use domain do you want to make claims about?
- How well does the corpus represent that population/domain?
- Are important groups, genres, tasks, proficiency levels, or time periods missing or unevenly represented?
- Is the corpus large and diverse enough for the feature(s) you want to investigate?
- What kinds of generalizations are reasonable based on this corpus?
- What claims should you avoid making?

Exercise 5. Submission

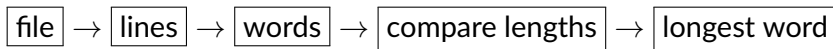
1. **Exercise 5:** Submit in any readable format (e.g., .txt, .docx, or .pdf) (1 point)
2. Add the corpus and the requested information to our **shared Google Sheet** (1 point); We will use this as a shared class repository that everyone can refer to when looking for corpora.

Appendix

Decompose the problem

Think about what needs to happen for **each line**:

1. Split the line into words.
2. Start with one word as the current longest word.
3. Look at each word one at a time.
4. Compare its length with the current longest word.
5. If it is longer, replace the current longest word.
6. Print the final result.



Moreover, most studies have examined only one type of LLM, leaving open the question of whether these linguistic changes are specific to one model or generalizable across other LLMs.

3 Methods

3.1 Dataset

This study utilizes the ICNALE Edited Essays dataset, one of the publicly available corpora within the International Corpus Network of Asian Learners of English (ICNALE) project (Ishikawa, 2018, 2021). The dataset comprises 656 essays written by 328 L2 learners and their edited versions produced by professional native English-speaking proofreaders.

The L2 participants were college students learning English in ten regional contexts: Japan (JPN), Korea (KOR), China (CHN), Taiwan (TWN), Indonesia (IDN), Thailand (THA), Hong Kong (HKG), the Philippines (PHL), Pakistan (PAK), and Singapore (SIN). Each participant wrote two argumentative essays in response to the prompts: (1) “It is important for college students to have a part-time job” and (2) “Smoking should be completely banned at all restaurants”.

3.1.1 Rationale for dataset selection and representativeness

The ICNALE dataset was chosen for three main reasons. First, it provides paired original and professionally proofread versions, allowing for direct comparison with LLM-generated outputs. Second, it includes explicit L2 proficiency labels, facilitating stratified analyses across proficiency levels. Last, it offers balanced regional coverage across ten Asian countries or regions (see Table 1). However, we acknowledge that broad generalizations to other genres or demographic groups (e.g., narrative writing, younger learners) must be made with caution.

Beglar, 2007). Table 1 shows the proficiency distribution of each regional learner group.

Region	A2_0	B1_1	B1_2	B2_0	Total
JPN	10	10	10	10	40
KOR	10	10	10	10	40
CHN	10	10	10	10	40
TWN	10	10	10	10	40
IDN	10	10	10	3	33
THA	10	10	10	2	32
HKG	–	10	10	10	30
PHL	–	10	10	10	30
PAK	–	10	10	3	23
SIN	–	–	10	10	20
Total	60	90	100	78	328

Table 1: Distribution of participants by region and proficiency

3.1.3 Proofreading process and proofreader profiles

The ICNALE project recruited five experienced proofreaders with strong academic backgrounds and extensive experience in editing scholarly work. Their profiles are summarized in Table 2.

ID	Age	Sex	Degree	Experience (years)	L1 English
A	28	Female	BA	3	Canadian
B	32	Female	MS	5	Australian
C	27	Female	BS	3	American
D	38	Female	BS	10	British
E	31	Female	PhD	2	Australian

Table 2: Profiles of proofreaders in the ICNALE project

As documented in the ICNALE project, the professional proofreaders were tasked with editing errors and inappropriate wording to ensure that each essay became fully intelligible (Ishikawa, 2021, p. 496). No standardized rubric or adjudication mechanism was imposed at the original corpus compilation stage. All revisions were performed in MS Word using the Track Changes function, which allowed every edit, addition, or deletion to